Team Contract Instructions

Your team contract template is divided into three major sections:

1. Establishing team procedures
2. Identifying expectations
3. Specifying the consequences for failing to follow these procedures and fulfill these expectations

Since the basic purpose of this team contract is to accelerate your team's development, to increase individual accountability for team tasks, and to reduce the possibility for team conflict, make your contract **as specific as possible**: (a) specify each task as detailed as possible, (b) specify each step in a procedure or process as detailed as possible, (c) specify the exact person(s) responsible for each specific task, and (d) specify the exact time and exact place for completion or submission of each task. The more specifically you describe your team expectations, roles, and procedures, the greater your chance for a successful team experience.

Use the Team Contract template to discuss and finalize your team roles, procedures, and standards. Complete, sign, and submit a **copy** of your finalized contract on Brightspace.

Once your team contract has been developed, your team will be ready to begin working on the project. However, you may soon find that your team is not working as well as you had hoped. This is normal but needs to be attended to immediately. Perhaps your team is simply not following the established contract procedures or roles as strictly as it should, or perhaps you need to change some of the procedures or roles as outlined in your contract. Call a team meeting immediately to discuss and resolve the challenges your team is facing; do not delay. Seek guidance from your TA or professor to resolve any conflicts a soon as possible if your team cannot resolve the issues on its own. Do not be afraid to seek help if necessary. The goal is to have the most positive team experience possible.

TEAM CONTRACT

ELG/DTI/GNG 5902, Section # __

Team Members:

1) Kair Wang

2) Jingxuan Xu

3) Xiaoyan Yang

4) Xiaoyi Zhang

5) Jiaoyang Bi

Suggested Projects:

1st choice: Project 5

2nd choice: Project 35

3rd choice: Project 3

Team Procedures

1. Day, time, and place for regular **team meetings**:

Every Sunday at 8:00 PM (EST) via Microsoft Teams. Additional meetings may be scheduled depending on project deadlines and sprint requirements.

In-person meetings may take place at the University of Ottawa library or STEM building when necessary.

2. Preferred method of **communication** (e.g. e-mail, cell phone, Facebook, Blackboard Discussion Board, face-to-face, in a certain class) in order to discuss the project and to inform each other of team meetings, announcement, updates, reminders, problems:

Primary communication will take place through a dedicated Discord server and WeChat group chat. Microsoft Teams will be used for official document sharing and meeting scheduling. Urgent matters should be communicated through direct messaging.

3. **Decision-making policy** (by consensus? by majority vote?):

Major project decisions will be made through team consensus whenever possible.
If consensus cannot be reached within a reasonable timeframe, a majority vote will be used.

4. Method for setting and following meeting **agendas** (Who will set each agenda? When? How will team members be notified/reminded? Who will be responsible for the team following the agenda during a team meeting? What will be done to keep the team on track during a meeting?):

The project coordinator will prepare and distribute the meeting agenda at least 12 hours before each meeting through Discord and Teams.

During meetings, one member will facilitate discussion and ensure the team remains on task and within the planned timeline. Action items and deadlines will be reviewed before the meeting ends.

5. Method of **record keeping** (Who will be responsible for recording & disseminating minutes? How & when will the minutes be disseminated? Where will all agendas & minutes be kept?):

The project coordinator will prepare and distribute the meeting agenda at least 12 hours before each meeting through Discord and Teams.

During meetings, one member will facilitate discussion and ensure the team remains on task and within the planned timeline.

Action items and deadlines will be reviewed before the meeting ends.

Team Expectations

Work Quality

1. **Project standards** (What is a realistic level of quality for team presentations, collaborative writing, individual research, preparation of drafts, peer reviews, etc.?):
   All submitted work should be professional, well-tested, properly documented, and reviewed by at least one additional team member before submission.
   Code should follow consistent formatting and version control practices.
   Presentations and reports should maintain clear structure, technical accuracy, and professional visual quality.

2. **Strategies** to fulfill these standards:
   The team will use GitHub for version control, peer reviews for major deliverables, and sprint-based task tracking through Trello or GitHub Projects.
   Internal deadlines will be set at least 48 hours before official deadlines to allow time for revisions and integration testing.

Team Participation

1. Strategies to ensure cooperation and equal distribution of tasks:

   Tasks will be divided based on each member's strengths, technical background, and availability.

   Workload distribution will be reviewed regularly to ensure fairness and balanced contribution.

2. Strategies for encouraging/including ideas from <u>all</u> team members (team maintenance):

   All team members are encouraged to contribute ideas during meetings and discussions.

   Feedback should remain respectful, constructive, and solution-oriented.

3. Strategies for keeping on task (task maintenance):
   The team will maintain weekly sprint goals and monitor progress through task boards and milestone tracking.
   Members are expected to provide updates regularly and communicate blockers as early as possible.

4. Preferences for leadership (informal, formal, individual, shared):
   Leadership responsibilities will be shared among the team, with one project coordinator responsible for organizing meetings, monitoring timelines, and facilitating communication.

Personal Accountability

1. Expected individual attendance, punctuality, and participation at all team meetings:
   Team members are expected to attend all scheduled meetings on time unless prior notice is given.
   Repeated absence without communication is considered a violation of team expectations.

2. Expected level of responsibility for fulfilling team assignments, timelines, and deadlines:
Members are expected to complete assigned tasks before deadlines and maintain professional accountability for their contributions.

3. Expected level of communication with other team members:

Members are expected to complete assigned tasks before deadlines and maintain professional accountability for their contributions.

4. Expected level of commitment to team decisions and tasks:

Once a team decision has been finalized, all members are expected to support and contribute toward the agreed direction.

Consequences for Failing to Follow Procedures and Fulfill Expectations

1. Describe, as a group, how you would handle **infractions** of any of the obligations of this team contract:

The team will first discuss the issue directly with the member involved and attempt to resolve the problem collaboratively.

2. Describe what your team will do **if the infractions continue**:

If the issue continues, the team will document the incidents and notify the TA or professor for further guidance.

Persistent lack of contribution may result in task reassignment and formal reporting according to course policies.

****

a) *I participated in formulating the standards, roles, and procedures as stated in this contract.*
b) *I understand that I am obligated to abide by these terms and conditions.*
c) *I understand that if I do not abide by these terms and conditions, I will suffer the consequences as stated in this contract.*

1) Kair Wang Project Coordination, Product Planning, Front-end date May 8, 2026

2) Jingxuan Xu Backend/API integration date May 8, 2026

3) Xiaoyan Yang UI/Tesing/Documentaion date May 8, 2026

4) Xiaoyi Zhang Database/Front-end/Testing date May 8, 2026

5) Jiaoyang Bi Ducumentation/ Full stack/ Dev support date May 8, 2026

* This template was adapted from https://cns.utexas.edu/images/CNS/TIDES/teaching-portal/**Team_Contract**.doc